CHAPTER 11

USING MAILLIST TO PRINT FORM LETTERS

In this chapter you'll learn about

- Creating a Mailing List
- Editing a Mailing List
- Creating a Form Letter
- Printing Form Letters

WordStar has a feature called MailList that lets you store names, addresses, and other information in a data file or mailing list. You can use merge printing commands to insert information from the mailing list into a form letter. Also, you can print the mailing list onto labels and envelopes. For more information on the variety of tasks that you can complete with MailList, see the *Companion Programs* manual.

CREATING A MAILING LIST

To create a mailing list in MailList, follow these steps:

1. At the Opening screen, choose Additional→MailList (A,M).

   The MailList Menu appears.

2. Press C to choose a data file. (A mailing list is kept in a file called a data file.)

3. Type **customer.dta** and press Enter to create a data file.

4. Press A to add records to the data file. A record is the information about one person on the mailing list.

   The data entry form appears on the screen. Each area for entering information on the form is called a field. The cursor is at the Record Number field.

5. Type 1 and then press Enter. You've assigned the number 1 to the first record.

   The cursor moves to the *Date* field.

6. Type **102592** and press Enter.

   The date appears as 10/25/92.

7. Fill in the rest of the form so that it looks like the following screen.

```
FORM:C:WSLIST              A D D   N E W   R E C O R D S              C:CUSTOMER.DTA
   ^Copy from previous record      ^Write/save record in file     F1   Help
                                                                    Escape
                          Type data and press ←┘.

     Record Number: 00001 Albert G. Alvarez                    Date: 10/25/92
           Mr./Ms.: Mr._____                                         mm/dd/yy
First, Init., Last: Albert_____ G.  Alvarez_________ Jr./M.D.: _________
             Title: English Teacher_____________________

           Company: Write School_____________________
    Address Line 1: 2330 Lark Ave._____________________
    Address Line 2: ___________________________________
  City, State, Zip: Buena Vista_________ CA_ 95912____
           Country: ___________________________________
           Phone-1: 101-555-7676______________________
           Phone-2: ___________________________________
User Fields-          Remarks-
1: _______________    ____________________________________________________
2: _______________    ____________________________________________________
3: _______________    ____________________________________________________
```

If you don't need to fill in a field, press Enter to skip to the next field. If you make a typing error, you can erase characters with the Backspace key or the Del key. You can move the cursor around the form using the commands listed below:

TO MOVE	PRESS
Left one character	^S or ←
Right one character	^D or →
To the previous field	^A or ^ ←
To the next field	^F or ^ →
To the top (first) field	^T or Home
To the last field	^L or End

8 Check to make sure you typed everything correctly in the form.

9 Press ^W to save this information in the data file.

10 Press Enter to save the record.

Now you'll add two more records to the data file.

1 For each record, repeat steps 4–10, substituting the information shown below:

```
FORM:C:WSLIST      V I E W   A N D   E D I T   R E C O R D S      C:CUSTOMER.DTA

   ^Previous/^Next record        ^Write/save modified record        F1   Help

   ^Erase record                 ^Create/change record filter       Escape

                    Type any changes and press ←┘.

     Record Number: 00002 Mary E. Bowen                          Date: 10/25/92
           Mr./Ms.: Ms._____                                           mm/dd/yy
First, Init., Last: Mary_____ E.  Bowen_____            Jr./M.D.: _____
             Title: Principal_____

           Company: Dogwood School_____
    Address Line 1: 1 Schoolhouse Road_____
    Address Line 2: _____
  City, State, Zip: Lynville_____ OH_ 47308____
           Country: _____
           Phone-1: 101-555-7497_____
           Phone-2: _____
User Fields-          Remarks-
1: _____              _____
2: _____              _____
3: _____              _____
```

```
FORM:C:WSLIST            A D D   N E W   R E C O R D S            C:CUSTOMER.DTA

   ^Copy from previous record    ^Write/save record in file         F1   Help

                                                                    Escape

                    Type data and press ←┘.

     Record Number: 00003 Lucy Hannis                            Date: 10/25/92
           Mr./Ms.: Ms._____                                           mm/dd/yy
First, Init., Last: Lucy_____ ___ Hannis_____           Jr./M.D.: _____
             Title: English Teacher_____

           Company: Oakvale High School_____
    Address Line 1: 770 Burton St._____
    Address Line 2: _____
  City, State, Zip: Oakvale_____ KY_ 32701____
           Country: _____
           Phone-1: 513-555-0380_____
           Phone-2: _____
User Fields-          Remarks-
1: _____              _____
2: _____              _____
3: _____              _____
```

2 When you finish typing and saving all three records, press Esc.

The MailList menu appears.

You now have information about three customers in your mailing list.

EDITING A MAILING LIST

Once you've added records to a mailing list, you can look at them and make changes at any time. Follow these steps to look through your records and make a correction.

1 At the MailList menu, press V to view and edit records.

The first record appears on your screen.

2 Press ^N to see the next record.

3 Press ^P to see the previous record.

4 Press ^P again.

A message says that you're at the beginning of the file.

5 Press Esc to go to the end of the file.

6 Correct Ms. Hannis's name to Ms. Harris. Use the same commands to move the cursor as you did while adding records.

7 Press ^W to save the updated record.

8 Press Enter to save the data.

9 Press Esc.

10 Press Q to exit MailList.

CREATING A FORM LETTER

You're now ready to write a letter to each customer on the mailing list. You'll create this letter, called a form letter, with WordStar and use merge printing commands to insert names and addresses from the mailing list.

Start at the WordStar Opening screen.

1. Open a new file.

2. Choose Insert→File (Alt+I,F). Select the file MAILLIST.DOT. (Include a path for the MAILLIST.DOT file. It's in the same directory as your MailList program files, usually WS\OPTIONS.)

   MAILLIST.DOT contains the dot commands you need in a form letter.

3. Move the cursor to the line beginning with **.df**.

   The **.df** dot command defines the data file as WSLIST.DTA. (WSLIST.DTA is the WordStar default file for a main mailing list.) You want to use CUSTOMER.DTA, the data file you created.

4. Delete WSLIST.DTA and type **\ws\options\customer.dta**. (Substitute the correct directory names. MailList creates the data files in the directory that contains the MailList program files, usually WS\OPTIONS.)

   Notice that the next four lines begin with **.rv**. The words in these lines are names that correspond to the fields on the mailing list form. You'll use these names in the letter where you want to insert data from the mailing list file.

5. Move the cursor to the blank line above the line which reads *(Type text and variable names here.)* Press ^Y twice to delete this line and the line that follows so they don't appear in the letter.

6. Type the following letter.

```
Theatre in the Park
50 Main St.
Franklin, CA 93701

November 15, 1992

&full-name&
&company&
&addr1&
&city&, &state& &zip&

Dear &Mr-Ms& &last&:

It's time to renew your subscription for the Theatre in
the Park summer series.  Your seat from last season will
be reserved for you unless you notify us that you wish to
change it.

If you know others at &company& who might be interested in
Theatre in the Park, please ask them to contact us for
more information.

Sincerely,

Sam Hergen
```

7 When you're finished, check your work.

All the words enclosed in ampersands (&) are called *variable names*. Use variable names wherever you want to insert information from the data file. Variable names must match the corresponding names in the **.rv** dot commands.

8 Be sure that all the text is above **.pa**, the dot command that tells WordStar to start a new page.

9 Save the file and name it THEATRE.DOC.

PRINTING FORM LETTERS WITH THE MAILING LIST

Now you'll print three letters using your mailing list and the original form letter.

1. Be sure your printer is on and ready.

2. At the Opening screen, choose File→Print (F,P).

   Note: In the Print dialog box, Interpret Merge Variables is selected by default. This means the merge print commands in your document will be interpreted by WordStar at print time.

3. Select THEATRE.DOC as the file to print. Press F10 or choose OK to start printing.

Three letters are printed, one to each person on the mailing list. The first letter looks like this:

Now that you've created a mailing list and a form letter and used them together to print individual letters, you've learned the basics of MailList and merge printing.

```
Theatre in the Park
50 Main St.
Franklin, CA 93701

November 15, 1992

Albert G. Alvarez
Write School
2330 Lark Ave.
Buena Vista, CA, 95912

Dear Mr. Alvarez:

It's time to renew your subscription for the Theatre in the Park
summer series.  Your seat from last season will be reserved for
you unless you notify us that you wish to change it.

If you know others at Write School who might be interested in
Theatre in the Park, please ask them to contact us for more
information.

Sincerely,

Sam Hergen
```